Umair Sayeed

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PROJECTS

Something Rotten in the States? FIFA World Cup '26 — Independent research *August 2026*

- Wrote an essay on the 2026 tournament: how modern players outgrow fixed positions, how national teams rebuild chemistry in weeks, and how the tournament's economics for fans and host cities compare with 1994.
- Built a Python pipeline turning FIFA's reports for all 104 matches into team, player, passing and shot data.
- Shipped two interactive atlases: playing styles for all 48 teams, and 600+ players grouped into 17 roles based on their tournament data, with similar-player search.

The Market for Peaches — Independent research *July 2026*

- Analyzed the US labor market by age, skills, occupation and industry, building a Python pipeline that combines BLS, CPS and O*NET data, with regression across multiple specifications.
- Found that jobs requiring prior experience grow faster and pay about 25% more while the young workforce shrinks, pointing to a 2030s bidding war for skilled workers.
- Built an explorer joining BLS employment projections with AI exposure and workforce age for all 832 detailed occupations.

Visible Value: Wage Determination in Major League Soccer — MSc Dissertation *September 2025*

- Tested whether MLS wages follow performance or popularity, using performance, salary and search data for 440 players.
- Found roster designation alone explains half of salary variance, more than performance, popularity and club combined. Top slots go mostly by age and position: players around 30 and attackers are favored, and defenders rarely get one whatever their numbers.
- Attacking and progressive play earn a premium and defensive work earns none; released an interactive simulator for reweighting performance against 2025 salaries.

EXPERIENCE

Data Analyst — Sounds True, Denver, CO *May 2023 – January 2024*

- Main analytics person for leadership, marketing, web and engineering; worked with the CFO and CTO on KPIs, forecasts and campaign results that guided budget.
- Rebuilt messy legacy databases in SQL into clean datasets teams could use on their own.
- Launched the company's first KPI dashboard (Sisense) for revenue, ROI and engagement.

Financial Analyst — Bloomberg LP, Princeton, NJ *January 2022 – February 2022*

- Built scenario and forecasting models from Bloomberg Terminal data and ran budget-vs-actuals analysis for senior analysts and strategy leads.

Research Analyst — ZS Wireless LLC, East Windsor, NJ *January 2020 – December 2020*

- Built market-sizing and competitive-benchmarking models for wireless and satellite markets, using FCC spectrum licensing and auction data.
- Modeled 5G and satellite broadband adoption from market data and expert input; turned results into client forecasts and reports.

EDUCATION

MSc Economics — University of St Andrews, Scotland *September 2024 – December 2025*

BA Mathematics & Data Science — Drew University, Madison, NJ *September 2017 – May 2021*

SKILLS

Tools: Python (pandas, scikit-learn) | R (fixest) | SQL | Snowflake | Stata | Excel | Sisense | Tableau | Power BI | Bloomberg Terminal | Git/GitHub | ETL & Data Pipelines

Methods: Data Science | Data Analysis | Statistical Programming | Econometrics | Causal Inference | Machine Learning | Panel Data & Regression | Clustering & PCA | Forecasting | AI Literacy | Market & Competitive Research | Football/Soccer Analytics | Data Visualization | Statistical Modeling

Languages: English | Bengali | Spanish

VOLUNTEERING & ADDITIONAL

Disaster Relief (American Legion) | Community Initiatives (NJ Rise) | Academic Tutoring (NHS) | Youth Football Coaching (EWPAL) | Coauthor & Lobbyist (S. 3191 Civil Rights Cold Case Records Collection Act of 2018)